

Partnership Proposal: GGP × Take-Two Interactive

Renew the baseline, expand with the Directory · 12 Months · July 2026 to July 2027

To: Alan Lewis, Chair, Take-Two Charitable Giving Committee

From: Gordon Bellamy, CEO, Gay Gaming Professionals; Professor of the Practice, USC

Read-ahead for: the next standing EXCELLENCE cadence meeting

This proposal has two parts. First, **renew the baseline** that already works, now as clear, separate line items. Second, **expand with the Directory**, our highest-priority new asset. The recommended Option B does both, inside the budget envelope you already operate in.

Part 1 · The Baseline (renew)

RENEW · SEPARATE LINE ITEMS

- **GGP Scholars — \$30,000.** Dedicated support for the flagship cohort, seven years running in GGP's 20th year. Take-Two recognized as a GGP Scholars supporter.
- **CYSTEM Scholars — \$25,000.** Take-Two as a valued co-funder of the CYSTEM graduate cohort — top-performing graduate students from USC, CMU, and NYU, each paired one-on-one with an industry mentor. CYSTEM is supported alongside the Bigglesworth and Houser foundations; this is a co-funding role, not sole sponsorship.
- **2K Studio Tour at GDC — in-kind.** Take-Two continues to cover the transportation and coordination that bring the GGP and CYSTEM scholars to the tour each year, a tradition Alan personally joins. Credited here, not a cash ask.

The baseline is **\$55,000 in direct support** (\$30K GGP Scholars + \$25K CYSTEM), plus the 2K Studio Tour that Take-Two already makes possible. This is the floor, and it grows the relationship rather than stepping back from it.

Part 2 · The Expansion (priority)

NEW · HIGHEST PRIORITY

- **The Directory — \$40,000.** The US Video Game Education and Scholars Pipeline, a board-ready map of the field from elementary through graduate, with AI readiness as a first-class category and a “where dollars go furthest” tag on every entry. Launches at gaygamingpros.org/directory this summer with Take-Two as named launch partner. Funds the public launch, Year-1 maintenance, a donor-facing dashboard, an AI-readiness overlay, and verified outcomes for the top programs. (A starter directory today; the build-out expands and verifies coverage.)
- **AI Readiness Track — \$5,000.** An “AI in the Studio” module added to CYSTEM, 1 to 2 office hours led by Take-Two engineers, and an “AI in the Studio” segment inside the 2K Studio Tour at GDC 2027.

With Take-Two as launch partner, the Directory stops being our cohort's resource and becomes the field's infrastructure, a public good with your name on the front door, across both GDC and USC.

Options

Option	Investment	What it is
A • Renew the Baseline	\$55,000	GGP Scholars (\$30K) + CYSTEM Scholars (\$25K). Every tradition continues, including the in-kind 2K Studio Tour.
B • Baseline + Directory + AI 🌟	\$100,000	Everything in A, plus the Directory (\$40K) and the AI Readiness Track (\$5K).
C • Flagship	\$125,000	Option B plus the Collegiate Games Challenge 2027 sponsorship.

Add-on, available at any tier: sponsor the **Collegiate Games Challenge 2027** — our national university competition (\$90,000 awarded to students in its inaugural year) — for **\$25,000**.

Recommendation: Option B • \$100,000. It renews every tradition, funds the Directory, adds the AI layer 2026 calls for, and stays inside your existing envelope.

What Option B delivers

- The Directory launches publicly by Pride 2026, with a launch press cycle and the top programs verified; quarterly refresh thereafter
- The GGP Scholars flagship cohort supported for the year
- The CYSTEM graduate cohort (USC, CMU, NYU) co-funded, with 1-on-1 Take-Two ERG mentors
- GGP and CYSTEM scholars hosted at the 2K Studio Tour and the Scholars Breakfast at GDC 2027
- The “AI in the Studio” module delivered to the cohort

What we need from Take-Two

- Alan as point person, with a 2K and Zynga ERG liaison
- Launch-partner brand approval for the Directory and staged co-branding rights
- ERG access: mentors for the cohort and 1 to 2 AI engineer office hours
- An MOU and contract. Option B paid in three tranches: 50% at kickoff (July 2026), 25% at Directory launch, 25% at GDC 2027

Risk + mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Budget constraint in 2026	Option A (baseline only, \$55K) is the fallback; components are modular
Directory launch delays	Phased release (beta then public); decoupled from GDC 2027 deliverables
Mentor matching	GGP pre-recruits Take-Two ERG mentors; office hours scheduled in advance
Outcomes data not yet complete	Top programs verified at launch; the longer tail is filled across the year

Why GGP

- **Track record.** 20 years cultivating top performers. First GGP Scholar Alum on Forbes 30 Under 30 (Games, Sept 2025): Joseph Kemp, CEO of Games That Matter LLC. Audrey Webb at Roblox. Ami Cai at NYS Empire State Development. Christopher Kim at USC Marshall.
- **Ecosystem position.** Five programs across the pipeline (GGP Scholars, CYSTEM, Collegiate Games Challenge, Global Game Jam host, GGP × G4C funded scholars). Tracy Fullerton (USC Games) and Ben Golant (Tencent) are on the G4C board with us.
- **Operational stability.** Eric Francksen formally takes the title Executive Producer, GGP, in 2026. Six years of operational backbone behind the 2K Studio Tour, the Scholars Breakfast, and the CYSTEM cadence with Take-Two.

Soon, and separate: our GGP Scholars brunch is Monday, July 20 in NYC, the day after the World Cup Final (venue confirming). Alan, you are invited, and since the team is in the city, if there is anything we could do with some of the scholars at Take-Two that day, we will build the day around it.

Next step

A 30-minute call at the next EXCELLENCE cadence to confirm Option B (or remix), co-develop the Directory launch comms for the Pride 2026 window, lock the tranche structure, and calendar the GDC 2027 moment.

Name the date and we will be there.

Built to be shared with the Take-Two Charitable Giving Committee. The Directory is the asset this proposal puts in your committee's hands. Companion: the US Video Game Education and Scholars Pipeline starter directory (linked separately, fact-checked June 17, 2026).